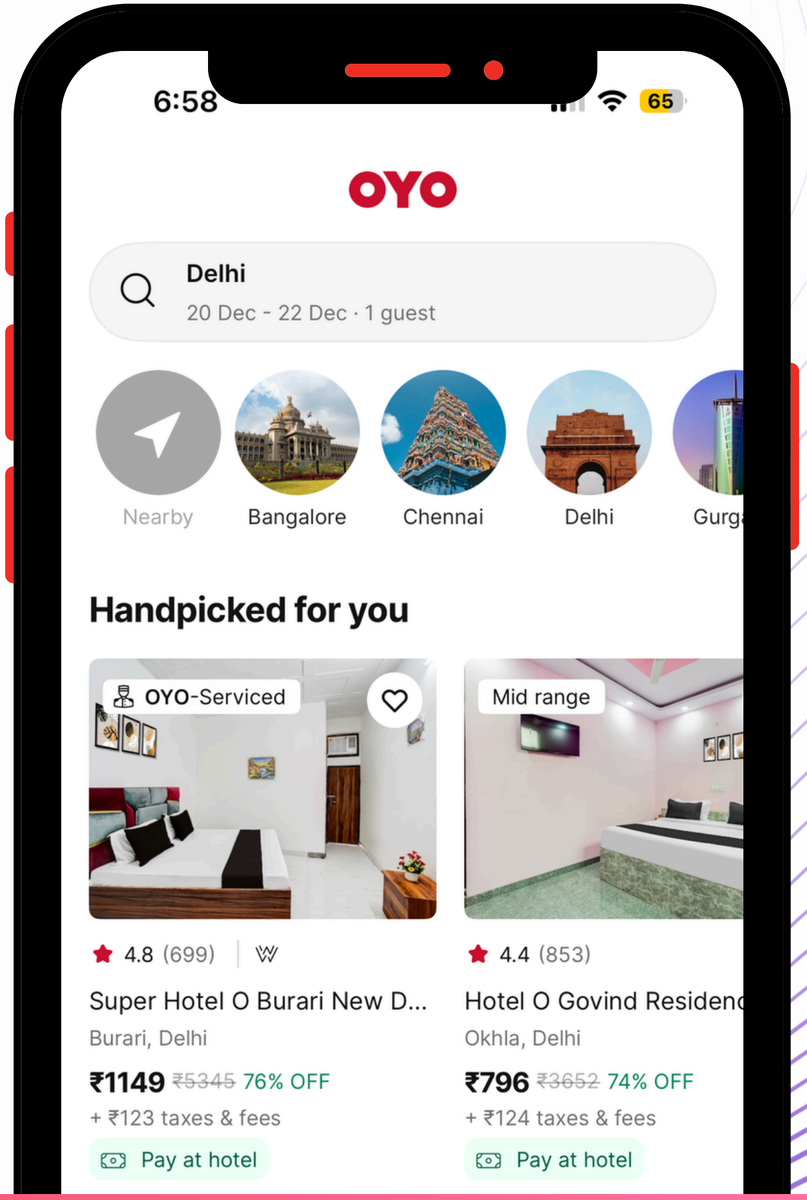
OYO ROOMS

Product Case Study • October 2026

Group Trips Deserve a Group Product. Exploring the group travel opportunity in OYO's booking experience, and designing a feature to unlock it.

Arnav Jain | B.Tech IT, NSUT Delhi

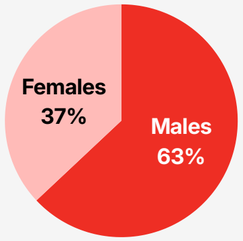


OYO ROOMS **by PRISM**

Founded in 2013 by Ritesh Agarwal. India's largest budget hospitality chain, operating 157,000+ hotels across 35 countries.

Mission: **"To create beautiful, enjoyable stays."**

Key Figures

GLOBAL SCALE	INDIAN SCALE	DEMOGRAPHICS
174K+	100M+	
Storefronts	App downloads	
35+	80%	
Countries	Bookings via App	
1M+	500+	
Rooms Listed	Cities Active	Largest Segment 18–34 yrs

Growth Timeline

2013 — OYO Founded
First OYO opens in Gurugram

2018 — Goes Global
UK, China & Indonesia

2021 — 100M Users
App crosses 100M downloads

2024 — First Profit
₹229 Cr PAT achieved

2025 — PRISM Era
Rebranded & IPO filed

From 1 hotel in Gurugram to 174,000+ hotels across 35 countries in just 8 years.

Group Travel is Booming. Booking is Still a Solo Experience.

🧳 Group Travel is the Norm

60%+ of leisure trips in India involve 2 or more people



💳 One Person Pays for Everyone

No split payment: 1 person fronts ₹15000, chases friends forever



📱 Competitors Already Solved It

Airbnb launched group booking tools in 2024. OYO hasn't.

FOR THE ORGANIZER

- Pays the full hotel cost upfront alone
- Chases friends for days to get paid back
- Manages all group comms himself
- No way to share booking details in-app

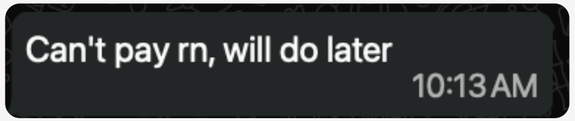
"I love planning trips. I hate being the group banker." — Arjun, 26



FOR THE INVITEE

- Has zero visibility of what was booked
- Gets bombarded with payment reminders
- Doesn't know check-in time or room details
- No agency in the planning process

"Just tell me where to show up." — Riya, 24



60% GROUP TRIPS

Roughly 60%+ of leisure trips in India are group trips, yet OYO's entire booking flow is built for a single person. The Organizer always pays. The Invitee never knows. This is the gap this feature needs to close.

*Source: Industry travel trends (2024)

👤 26-year-old First-Time Group Trip Organizer



Arjun Mehta

"I love planning trips. I hate being the group banker."

Age: 26

Occupation: Software Engineer

Location: Bengaluru

Personality

- Planner
- Detail-oriented
- Leader
- Responsible

Psychographics: Lifestyle

- → Plans 2–3 group trips per year (Goa, Coorg, Manali)
- → Takes full ownership of booking logistics for the group
- → Compares options on OYO, MakeMyTrip and Google Hotels
- → Coordinates everything through WhatsApp groups

Behaviour

- → Searches and selects hotels alone, even for group trips
- → Screenshots the booking page and pastes into WhatsApp
- → Follows up 5–6 times to collect money from friends
- → Feels burdened and anxious in the lead-up to every trip

Pain Points

- → Financial burden: pays ₹15,000 upfront alone
- → No split payment: OYO offers no way to divide the cost for the group
- → Communication overhead: manages all updates via WhatsApp
- → No group confirmation: friends don't get their own booking details

Needs

- → A way for each group member to pay their own share
- → In-app sharing of booking details with all members
- → A shared group planning space so WhatsApp isn't the only tool

👤 24-year-old Stress-Averse Group Traveller



Riya Sharma

"Just tell me where to show up."

Age: 24

Occupation: Marketing Executive

Location: Mumbai

Personality

- Carefree
- Spontaneous
- Social
- Easy-going

Psychographics: Lifestyle

- → Loves travelling with friends but hates organising anything
- → Prefers to be told what to do, not plan it
- → Uses GPay/PhonePe daily but pays back only when nudged
- → Checks WhatsApp frequently, ignores group chats

Behaviour

- → Ignores the WhatsApp group until the trip is very near
- → Doesn't know the hotel name or check-in time until day-of
- → Pays Arjun back only after 3–5 direct reminders
- → Feels guilty about the burden on Arjun but doesn't know how to help

Pain Points

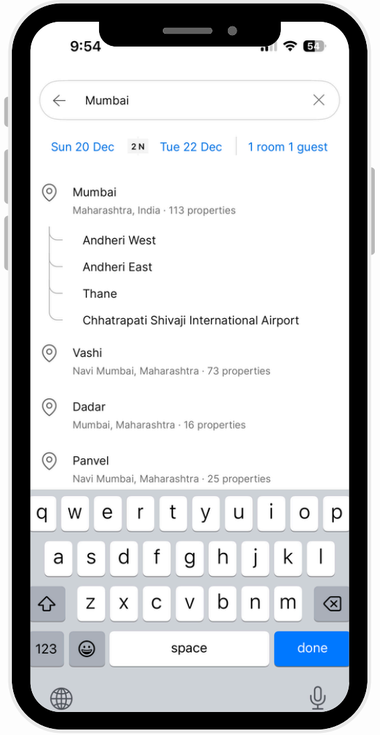
- → Constant reminders: chased for payment repeatedly
- → No visibility: doesn't know what was booked or when
- → Feels excluded: no agency in the planning process
- → Guilt: knows she's causing Arjun stress but can't fix it

Needs

- → Her own direct payment link: pay her share instantly without asking
- → A personal booking confirmation she can save and refer to
- → Hotel details (address, check-in time) pushed to her directly

The Current Journey (Broken)

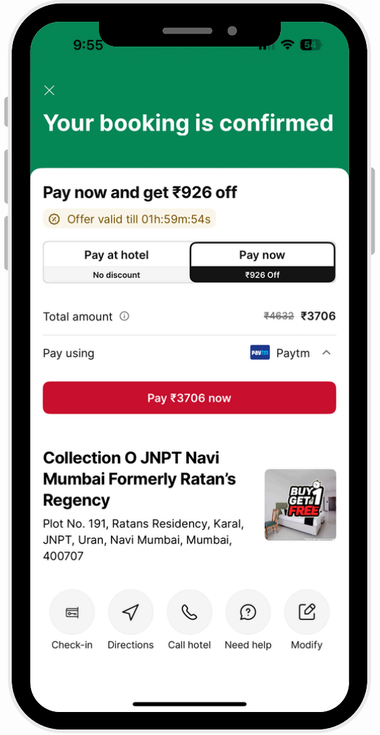
Step 01: Search & Select



User Actions:
Arjun searches for a weekend getaway for 4 friends.

Pain Point:
The app is hardcoded for solo bookings. No "Group Trip" mode exists.

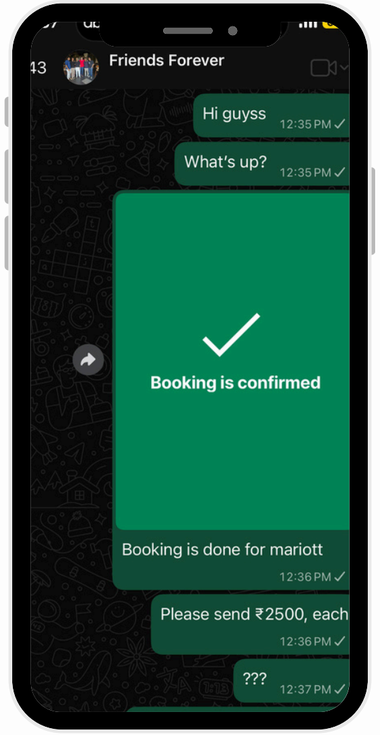
Step 02: Checkout & Pay



User Actions:
Arjun reaches checkout and has to pay the entire ₹15,000 hotel bill himself.

Pain Point:
No split payment option. The financial burden falls 100% on the organizer.

Step 03: The Aftermath



User Actions:
Arjun drops the booking SS on WhatsApp, begging for GPays.

Pain Point:
Moving off-app leaves friends in the dark and turns Arjun into a debt collector.

The Market Gap

Platform	Group Booking	Split Pay	Group Confirmation
OYO	🔴 Not Built	🔴 Not Built	🔴 Not Built
airbnb	🟢 Supported	🟢 Supported	🟢 Supported
make my trip	🟢 Supported	🔴 Not Built	🔴 Not Built

OUR GOAL: BUILD "OYO TRIPS"

Shared Space
Let users invite friends to plan and decide together.

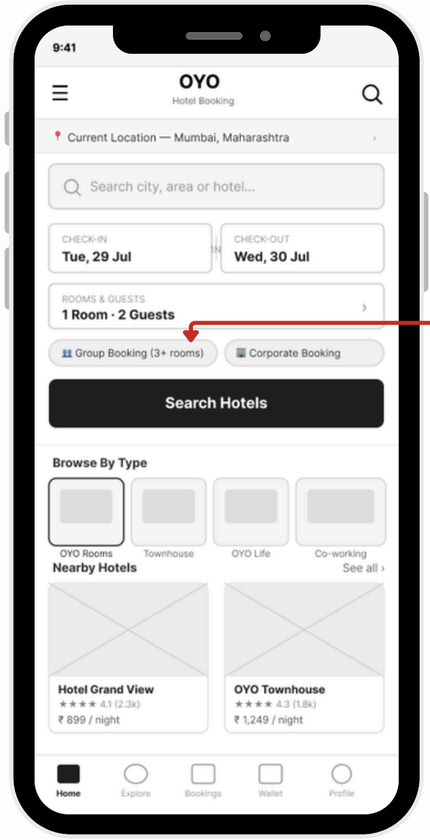
Split Payments
Allow everyone to pay their own exact share via UPI directly.

Group Visibility
Give every invited member their own booking confirmation.

Introducing OYO Trips

A native group booking experience built into OYO. Three screens. One seamless flow.

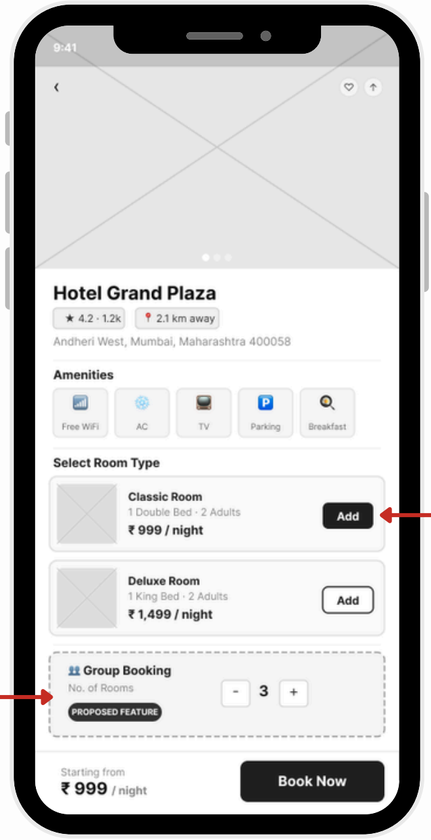
SCREEN 1: Group Search



Group Mode Toggle
Switches entire app to multi-room booking flow

Room Stepper
Select how many rooms the group needs

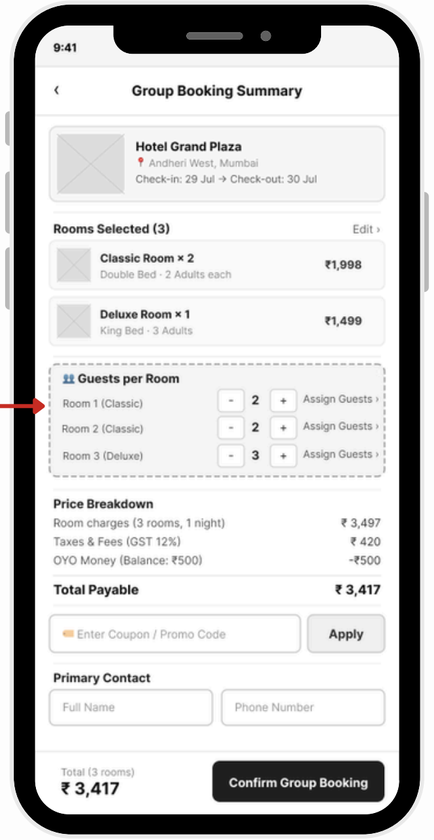
SCREEN 2: Hotel & Room Pick



Per-Person Pricing
Each room shows cost split per member

Guest Assignment
Each member gets their own UPI payment link

SCREEN 3: Group Checkout



Overview | User Research | User Journey | **Feature Design** | Success Metrics

How We Measure OYO Trips Success

NORTH STAR METRIC

Group Bookings as % of Total Bookings

Target: 15% within 12 months
Now: ~0%

PRIMARY METRICS

📈 Adoption Rate

20% of all 3+ room bookings use OYO Trips feature

💰 Avg Order Value

₹8,000+ per group booking (vs ₹1,200 solo avg)

💳 Split Pay Completion

85%+ of group payments collected in-app within 24hrs

🔁 90-Day Retention

40%+ of group bookers return for next trip via OYO

📅 Rollout Plan

M1-2:	Beta launch in Bengaluru & Mumbai
M3:	Analyse drop-offs, fix UX gaps
M4-6:	Full pan-India rollout
M9:	Add WhatsApp invite + group chat integration
M12:	Review: hit 15% group booking share

🛡️ Guardrail Metrics

- Solo booking conversion rate must not drop (baseline ±2%)
- Payment-related support tickets must decrease by 30%
- App crash rate on group flow must stay below 0.5%

THANK YOU!